questions about the role of human judgment in warfare. Delegating life-and-death decisions to algorithms risks eroding moral accountability, increasing the potential for unintended harm and civilian casualties. Consequently, international bodies such as the United Nations (UN) and the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) are advocating for global treaties that ensure “meaningful human control” over autonomous combat systems and adherence to international humanitarian law.

Furthermore, the widespread deployment of drones impacts societal ethics at multiple levels, ranging from surveillance culture and public trust to concerns about safety, bias in AI decision-making, and equitable access to technology. Without a clear ethical and legal framework, the same technology designed to protect and assist humanity could undermine privacy, security, and moral accountability.

7.5.1 Privacy concerns with widespread drone surveillance

The increasing use of drones for surveillance, monitoring, and data collection has sparked growing concern over privacy violations and the erosion of personal freedom. Modern drones, equipped with high-resolution cameras, night-vision systems, LiDAR sensors, and facial recognition technologies, can capture detailed images and data from considerable distances – often without the knowledge or consent of the individuals being observed. While these capabilities are invaluable in applications such as law enforcement, disaster management, and infrastructure inspection, they also raise profound ethical and legal questions about how, where, and by whom such surveillance should be conducted.

The most significant concern lies in the intrusive potential of continuous aerial monitoring. Unlike fixed surveillance cameras, drones are highly mobile, allowing them to access private spaces such as residential areas, backyards, and workplaces. This ability to collect real-time data across wide